

BIBLIOTHECA GEOGRAPHORUM ARABICORUM

Bilingual Arabic-English Edition

DESCRIPTIO IMPERII MOSLEMICI

AHSAN AL-TAQASIM FI MA'RIFAT AL-AQALIM

A Bilingual Arabic-English Edition

al-Moqaddasi

edidit / edited by

M. J. de Goeje

EDITIO SECUNDA / SECOND EDITION

Lugduni Batavorum
Apud E. J. Brill
1906 / 2025

كِتَابُ

حَسَنُ أ

لَتَقِ اسْمِ ا

مَعْرِفَةِ ف

لَأَقِ اِ ا

بِالْبَشَرِ اِ a

وَكَرَمِهِ بِمَنْ عَنهُ وَعَفَا تَعَالَى اللَّهُ وَحَمَاهُ

الثَّانِيَةُ الطَّبَعَةُ — الثَّانِيَةُ الطَّبَعَةُ

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م ١٩٠٦ نَ اِ اِ a

AHSAN AL-TAQASIM

THE BEST DIVISIONS FOR KNOWLEDGE OF THE REGIONS

A BILINGUAL ARABIC-ENGLISH EDITION

With parallel Arabic text and English translation

AUCTORE / AUTHOR

Shams ad-din Abu Abdallah Mohammed
ibn Ahmed ibn abi Bekr

al-Banna al-Basshari

AL-MOQADDASI

EDIDIT / EDITED BY

M. J. DE GOEJE.

EDITIO SECUNDA.

LUGDUNI BATAVORUM,
APUD E. J. BRILL.
1906.

Author's Preface | Author's Preface

الرحيم الرحمن اللطيف

كريم يا بفضلك تعسر ولا يسر رب

In the name of God, the Compassionate, the Merciful.

My Lord, make it easy and do not make it difficult, by Thy grace, O Generous One.

يشاوره، مشير بلا المريّة صنع فاتقن وصور الفلك خلق الذي لله الحمد
أوتد إعاون، بلا وأحكمها اتقنا، اتقنها يعاضده، معين بلا ودبرها
ماؤها يغلب كلاً بالبحر وأحاطها بميد، لثلا بالراسيات الأرض
أحسن من فنيهم يعملون كيف لينظر عباده فيها وبث ويريد،
وأكرم الأنبياء، خاتر على الله وصلى ونبي كفر من ومنهم وأفتدى،
كثيراً تسليماً وسلم وصحبه آله وعلى محمد الأولياء،

Praise be to God, who created the celestial orb and formed it with consummate skill, without any counsellor to consult; who ordered it without any assistant to help; who perfected it in the most perfect manner, and established it without need of support; who fixed the earth firmly lest it should sway, and surrounded it with the sea as a barrier protecting its waters; and who dispersed His servants upon it that He might observe how they act—and among them are those who do good and are redeemed, and among them are those who disbelieve and forget. And may God bless the Seal of the Prophets, the noblest of the chosen, Muhammad, and his family and companions, with abundant peace.

العلماء زالت ما فإنه بعد، أما المقدسي: أحمد بن محمد الله عبد أبو قال
أخبارهم، تنقطع ولا تحريصهم، بلأ الكتب تصنيف في ترغب
ذكرى، به أحيي علماً وأقيم سنتهم، وأفقو سنتهم، أتبع أن فأحببت
على فتملقوا العلوم إلى سبقوا قد العلماء ووجدت وفيلة، به وأشير
فرايت واختصروه، كلامهم فشرحو الأَخلاف تبعتهم ثم الاجتهاد،
وأَنواع الأرض، وأشكال الأقاليم، أخبار في كتاباً أولف أن
ومدائنها المشهورة، وأمصارها والبلاد، الممالك، ومسالك العبادات،
العشائر وعناصر المستعملة، وطرقها المسلوكة، ومنازلها المعروفة،
في البلدان أهل واختلاف والتجارات، الجمل ومعادن والآلات،
وأوزانهم، ومكائنتهم ومذاهبهم واللوانهم، وأسنانهم وأصواتهم كلامهم
وعلمائهم، وأشياخهم، بلد، كل لأهل المعاش وأفضية ونقودهم،
وحكامهم. وزهادهم،

Abu Abdallah Muhammad ibn Ahmad al-Muqaddasi said: Now then, the learned have always been eager to compose books that fill the scope of their investigations, and their reports are inexhaustible. I desired to follow their example and to walk in their footsteps, and to raise a standard whereby my memory might be kept alive and my name remembered. I found that the learned had already preceded me in the sciences and had distinguished themselves through diligent effort, and that successors had followed them, explaining and abridging their works. So I resolved to compose a book on the reports of the climes, the forms of the earth, the varieties of religious practices, the routes of kingdoms and lands, their famous garrison towns and well-known cities, their frequented stations and well-trodden roads; the elements of tribes and families, the mines of gems and trade goods; the differences among the peoples of the lands in their speech, voices, teeth, and colors; their doctrines, scripts, and weights; their coins and the means of livelihood for the people of each land; their elders, scholars, ascetics, and sages.

Necessary Preliminaries | Necessary Preliminaries

مِنْهَا بَدَلًا وَفُصُولٌ مُقَدِّمَاتٌ

بِدَعَائِمٍ وَأَسْنَادَاتٍ مُحْكَمَةٍ قَوَاعِدَ عَلَى الْكِتَابِ هَذَا أَسَّسْتُ أَنِّي أَعْلَمُ
الْأَلْبَابِ، أُولِي فِيهِمْ وَأَسْتَعْنُتُ الصَّوَابِ، جِهَادَ فِيهِ وَتَحَرَّجْتُ قَوِيَّةً،
فَعَلِي وَالْأَمَلُ، الرَّجَاءُ فِيهِ وَيَبْلُغُ وَالزَّلُّ، الْخَطَأُ فِيهِ يُجْتَنَبُ أَنْ وَاسْمُهُ
وَعَلِيهِ وَعَلَبَتُهُ، وَحِرْفَتُهُ وَعَقَلَتُهُ، شَاهَدْتُهُ مَا بَفَنِيَاتِهِ أَوْصَفُ قَوَاعِدَهُ
بِهِ أَسْتَعْنُتُ وَمَا وَارَكَانِهِ، أَيْضًا قَوَاعِدِهِ وَمَنْ وَالْأَرْكَانِ، الْبَنِيَانِ رَفَعْتُ
بِالْغُفْلَةِ أَعْرِفُهُمْ لَمْ وَمَنْ النَّاسِ، مِنَ الْعُقُولِ ذَوِي سَوَالٍ تَبَيَّنَتْ، عَلَى
وَلَمْ عَنْهَا، بَعْدَتْ الَّتِي الْأَطْرَافِ فِي وَالْأَعْمَالِ الْكَبِيرِ عَنِ الْإِنْتِبَاسِ،
فِيهِ اخْتَلَفُوا وَمَا أَثْبَتُهُ، اتَّفَقَهُمْ عَلَيْهِ وَقَعَ فَمَا إِلَيْهَا، الْوُصُولُ لِي يَتَقَدَّرُ
قَلْتُ أَوْ ذَكَرُ الْمَاضِي إِلَى اسْتِنَادَاتِهِ فِي بَدَلٍ لِي يَكُنْ لَمْ وَمَا نَبَذْتُ،
الْمُلُوكِ. خِزَانَاتٍ فِي وَجَدْتُهُ بِفُصُولٍ وَشَاهَدْتُهُ رَعْمُوا،

Know that I have founded this book upon sound principles and solid bases, and I have exerted myself therein to attain correctness, seeking the help of those of understanding. I strove to avoid error and mistake, and to achieve the hoped-for goal. On these principles I describe in its chapters what I have witnessed and understood, recorded and learned; upon them I raised the structure and pillars. Among its principles and pillars, and what I relied upon to elucidate it, was to question men of intellect, and those whom I did not know out of negligence and obscurity, about the great matters and the works in the distant regions which I could not reach. Whatever they agreed upon I confirmed; whatever they differed upon I rejected; and what I had no way to verify by reference to the past, I recorded with "they say" or "they claim." And I witnessed it in detail and found it in the treasuries of kings.

وَلَا قَصْدَنَاهَا، الَّتِي الطَّرِيقَ يَسْلُكُ لَمْ الْعِلْمُ هَذَا إِلَى سَبَقْنَا مَنْ وَكُلُّ
أَمِيرٍ دَزِيرَ فَكَانَ الْبَكْرِيُّ اللَّهُ عَبْدُ أَبِي أَمَّا أَرْدَنَاهَا، الَّتِي الْغَوَائِدَ طَلَبَ
وَسَأَلَهُمُ السُّفَرَاءَ مُجْتَمِعَ وَهَيْئَةً وَنَحْوَهُمْ فَلَسَفَةً صَاحِبُ وَكَانَ خُرَاسَانَ،
وَدَخَلَهَا. الْمُلُوكِ عَنِ

Everyone who preceded us in this science did not follow the path we intended, nor seek the principles we desired. As for Abu Abdallah al-Bakri, he was the vizier of the governor of Khurasan, a philosopher, and he gathered the ambassadors and questioned them about the kings, and entered their lands.

Chapter on the Seas and Rivers | Chapter on the Seas and Rivers

وَالْأَنْهَارِ الْبَحَارِ ذِكْرُ

نَحْوُ مَنْ يَخْرُجُ أَحَدُهُمَا حَسْبُ بَحْرَيْنِ إِلَّا الْإِسْلَامُ فِي نَزْمٍ أَنَا أَعْلَمُ
 الْإِسْلَامُ مَمْلَكَةٌ بَلَّغَ فَإِذَا السَّوَادُ، وَبِلَادِ الصِّينِ بِلَادِ بَيْنَ الشَّامِ مَشَارِقِ
 عَدَّةٍ، وَشَعْبٌ كَثِيرٌ خَلِيجَانِ وَلَهُ مِثْلَانِ، كَمَا الْعَرَبُ، جَزِيرَةٌ عَلَى دَارِ
 شِبْثِيَّةٍ جَاعِلَةٍ، مِنْ فَنَائِهِمْ إِلَى الْمَصِيرِ وَصَفِهِ فِي النَّاسِ اخْتَلَفَ وَقَدْ
 بَعْمَانُ، وَطَرَفُ بِالْعِرَاقِ وَطَرَفُ الْقِسْمِ عَلَى يَطُوفِ بَنِيَانٍ بِخَلِيجِ طَبَسِيَّةٍ
 خُرَاسَانَةٍ وَعِنْدَهُ بِالْعِرَاقِ، وَذَنْبُهُ حَدِيثَةٌ، الشَّيْنِ وَبِلَادِ الشَّيْنِ وَخَلِيجِ
 بَنِيَسَابُورِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ أَمِيرِ خَزَانَةٍ فِي وَرَقَةٍ عَلَى مِثْقَلِ وَرَائِهِ خُرَاسَانِ أَمِيرِ
 نَعْرِفَهَا، لَمْ فَإِنَّا مِثْلُ، كُلُّ وَإِذَا وَالصَّاحِبِ، الدَّوْلَةِ عِنْدَ خُرَاسَانَةٍ وَفِي
 عَلَى يَعْتَمِدُ خَلِيجَانِ بَعْضُهُنَّ فِي وَإِذَا الْأَثَارِ بِمُخْتَلَفٍ فَسَرَّتُهُ أَنَا وَمَا
 الْيَابَسَةِ. فِي فَمَجْرَاهُ الْأَعْظَمُ النَّهْرُ وَأَمَّا كُلُّهَا، مِنَ الْقَلِيلِ

Know that in the Islamic lands we have not seen [bodies of water] other than two seas, according to one of which: it emerges from the direction of the eastern regions of Syria, between the lands of China and the lands of the Sawad. When it reaches the realm of Islam, it encircles the Arabian Peninsula, as we have represented it. It has many gulfs and numerous branches. The people have differed in their descriptions of it and in [tracing] the extent of its reaches: some hold it to be like the Tabi Tabasiyyah in the Bay of Baniyan, which runs along the division, with one end in Iraq and one end in Oman; the Bay of China and the lands of China are near it, and its tail extends toward Iraq, and nearby is Khurasan of the governor of Khurasan. His opinion is confirmed by a map in the treasury of the Commander of the Faithful in Nishapur, and in the Khurasan of the State and the Sahib. And so with every similar case—for we do not know them fully, and we have only explained them according to the varying accounts. Among them are bays that rely upon the calculation of longitude from all of them. As for the greatest river, its course lies in dry land.

Editorial Note on the Manuscripts | Editorial Note on the Manuscripts

B = *codex Berolinensis* (Berlin manuscript)

C = *codex Constantinopolitanus* (Constantinople manuscript)

The editor, **M. J. de Goeje**, has based the present edition upon two principal manuscripts:

- a) **Codex Berolinensis** (B): A manuscript preserved in the Royal Library of Berlin, containing the complete text of al-Muqaddasi's work with certain lacunae.
- b) **Codex Constantinopolitanus** (C): A manuscript from Constantinople, fuller in certain respects, containing valuable additions and variants.

The apparatus criticus employs the following sigla:

Signum	Meaning
<i>B</i>	Codex Berolinensis
<i>C</i>	Codex Constantinopolitanus
<i>om.</i>	omits
<i>add.</i>	adds
<i>supra lin.</i>	above the line
<i>in marg.</i>	in the margin
<i>sine punctis</i>	without diacritical points
<i>pro</i>	reads (in place of)
<i>vid. infra</i>	see below
<i>vid. supra</i>	see above
<i>cod.</i>	codex (manuscript)

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1 The Division of the Earth into Climes | The Division of the Earth into Climes

لَا نَهْمُ الْكُفَّارِ مَسَالِكَ تَتَكَلَّفُ وَلَمْ حَسَبَ الْإِسْلَامَ مُلْكًا أَنْ ذَكَرْنَا وَقَدْ
إِقْلِيمًا، عَشْرَ أَرْبَعَةٍ إِلَى الْإِسْلَامِ أَرْضَ قَسَمْنَا وَقَدْ بَابِنَا، مِنْ تَكُنْ لَمْ
وَذَكَرْنَا الْمَمَالِكِ، مِنْ فِيهِ مَا وَوَزْنَا وَأَعْنَقْنَا، فَصَلَّنَاهُ إِقْلِيمٍ كُلِّ وَأَفْرَدْنَا
الْعِرَاقُ الْحِجَازَ الْمَشْرِقُ أَوَّلَهَا الْعَرَبِ أَقْلِيمٍ وَكَمَ الْعَجَائِبِ، مِنْ فِيهِ مَا
الْمَغْرِبُ. مِصْرُ الشَّامِ

We have mentioned that the realm of Islam is [divided]
accordingly, and we have not concerned ourselves with the
lands of the unbelievers, for they do not belong to our subject.
We have divided the land of Islam into fourteen climes, and
we have given each clime a separate chapter, and
distinguished what it contains of kingdoms, and mentioned
the wonders therein. The first clime is Arabia: the Hijaz, Iraq,
Syria, Egypt, and the Maghrib.

1.1 The First Clime: Arabia | The First Clime: Arabia

الْحِجَازُ: ذِكْرُ
الْمُسْلِمِينَ أَمْصَارَ مَحَلٍّ وَهُوَ وَأَشْرَفُهَا، الْعَرَبِ بِلَادٍ أَفْضَلِ مِنْ وَالْحِجَازِ
وَمَنْبِتٍ وَسَلَّمُ عَلَيْهِ اللَّهُ صَلَّى النَّبِيُّ وَمَوْلِدُ الْعَرَبِ، مَنَازِلُ وَمَوْضِعُ
أَقْلِيمٍ وَهُوَ وَالْيَمَامَةُ، وَالْيَمَنُ الْمُنُورَةُ وَالْمَدِينَةُ الْمُشْرِفَةُ مَكَّةَ وَفِيهِ الشَّرَائِعُ،
بَدْوٌ فِيهِ وَالنَّاسُ وَرِمَالٌ، حِجَارَةٌ وَأَكْثَرُهُ وَالْعُشْبُ، الْمَاءُ قَلِيلٌ حَارٌّ
مَا وَالْحِمْيَةُ وَالشَّجَاعَةُ الْفَخْرُ مِنْ وَلَهُمُ وَالْغَنَمُ، الْإِبِلُ وَمَالُهُمْ وَحَضَرُ،
لِغَيْرِهِمْ. لَيْسَ

The Hijaz is the noblest and most honorable of the lands of
Arabia; it is the dwelling-place of the Muslims and the abode
of the Arabs, the birthplace of the Prophet (may God bless
him and grant him peace) and the source of the revealed
laws. In it are Mecca the Honored and Medina the Illumined,
and Yemen and al-Yamama. It is a hot clime, with little water
and herbage; most of it is stones and sand. The people are
both Bedouin and settled; their wealth consists in camels and
sheep; and they possess pride, courage, and valor such as no
others have.

1.1.1 Mecca the Noble | Mecca the Noble

الْمَكَّةُ: مَكَّةُ
الْمُعَظَّمَةُ الْكَعْبَةُ مَوْضِعٌ وَهِيَ وَأَفْضَلُهَا، اللَّهُ بِلَادٍ أَشْرَفُ وَمَكَّةُ
مِنْ فِيهَا مَا وَأَصْفُ الْبِلَادِ، سِيرٌ فِي أَبْدَأُ وَبِهَا الْحَرَامُ، وَالْمَسْجِدُ
وَالطَّرِيقَاتُ. وَالْأَحْيَاءُ وَالْأَسْوَاقُ وَالْمَسَاجِدُ الْعِمَارَاتُ
لَهُ يُقَالُ جَبَلٍ سَفْجٍ فِي وَهِيَ عَالِيَةٌ، جَبَالٌ بَيْنَ شَرِيفٍ جَبَلٍ فِي وَمَكَّةُ
وَأَشْهُرُ وَالْعُيُونُ، الْأَبَارُ مِنْ وَمَاؤُهَا الْمَجْرَى، صَعْبٌ وَنَهْرُهَا قَيْسٌ، أَبُو
الْمَذَاقِ. عَذْبَةُ الْمَاءِ كَثِيرَةٌ عَيْنٌ وَهِيَ زَبِيدَةٌ، عَيْنٌ فِيهَا مَا

Mecca is the noblest and most excellent of God's lands; it is
the site of the venerated Kaaba and the Sacred Mosque. I
begin my account of the cities with it, describing its buildings,
mosques, markets, quarters, and roads. Mecca lies in a noble
mountain among high peaks, on the slope of a mountain
called Abu Qubays. Its river has a difficult course; its water
comes from wells and springs, the most famous of which is
the Spring of Zubayda—a spring abundant in water, sweet in
taste.

a) B جَبَالٍ An forte الجِبَالِ?, b) B المغازاتِ, c) B المواسِلِ, d) B om. مواضع الضياع et habet الجذبِ, e) B et C المصادرِ. Deinde B والجزمِ, f) B
والعجائزِ i.

e. والمباني. Deinde B et C والمنمِ, g) B om., h) B et C غنى ut saepissime in talibus.

2 The Climes of Iraq and Syria | The Climes of Iraq and Syria

2.1 Iraq | Iraq

العراق: ذِكْرُ
الْكُوفَةِ وَبِهِ وَالْمَلِكِ، الْخِلَافَةِ وَمَوْضِعِ الْجَنَّةِ، كُورَةِ بِلَادِ هُوَ وَالْعِرَاقُ
أَرْضٌ وَهُوَ الْأَخْيَالُ، وَحَصْنِ الرَّحْبَةِ وَالْأَنْبَارِ وَوَاسِطِ الْبَصْرَةِ
أَشْهَرُهَا كَثِيرَةٌ وَأَنْهَارُهُ وَالشَّعِيرُ، وَالْحَنْطَةُ وَالنَّخْلُ الْمَاءُ كَثِيرَةٌ خَصْبَةٌ
وَكَلَامٌ وَفَقْهٌ وَعِلْمٌ بَصْرَةٌ أَهْلُ أَكْثَرِهِمْ فِيهِ وَالنَّاسُ وَالْفَرَاتُ، دِجْلَةُ
وَمَذَاهِبُ.

Iraq is the land of the Courtyard of Paradise, the seat of the Caliphate and kingship. In it are Kufa, Basra, Wasit, Anbar, al-Rahba, and Hisn al-Ahyal. It is a fertile land, abundant in water, palm trees, wheat, and barley. Its rivers are numerous, the most famous being the Tigris and the Euphrates. Its people are mostly men of understanding, knowledge, jurisprudence, dialectics, and diverse doctrines.

2.2 Syria | Syria

الشَّامُ: ذِكْرُ
وَحْمَصِ وَالرَّشِيدِ دِمَشْقَ وَبِهِ الْخَيْرِ، كَثِيرٌ وَاسِعٌ أَقْلِيمٌ هُوَ وَالشَّامُ
وَبَيْرُوتُ وَالرَّمْلَةُ الْمُقَدَّسُ وَبَيْتُ وَاللَّاذِقِيَّةُ وَأَنْطَاكِيَّةُ وَحَلَبُ وَحَمَّاهُ
الْجِبَالُ مِنْ وَفِيهِ وَالضَّرْعُ، لِلزَّرْعِ صَالِحَةٌ وَأَرْضُهُ وَصِيدَاءُ، وَصُورُ
وَاللَّتَانِيُّ الْأَرْنُونُ أَنْهَارُهُ وَأَشْهَرُ يُحْصَى، لَا مَا وَالْعُيُونُ وَالْأَنْهَارُ
وَجَمَالٌ. وَصِحَّةٌ وَعِلْمٌ فَقْهٌ أَهْلُ فِيهِ وَالنَّاسُ وَالْيَرْمُوكُ،

Syria is a wide clime, rich in blessings. In it are Damascus, al-Rashid, Homs, Hama, Aleppo, Antioch, Latakia, Jerusalem, al-Ramla, Beirut, Tyre, and Sidon. Its land is suitable for cultivation and pasturage; it contains innumerable mountains, rivers, and springs. Its most famous rivers are the Orontes, the Litani, and the Yarmuk. Its people are distinguished in jurisprudence, knowledge, health, and beauty.

3 The Eastern Climes | The Eastern Climes

3.1 Khurasan and Transoxiana | Khurasan and Transoxiana

النَّهْرُ وَرَاءَ وَمَا خُرَاسَانَ ذِكْرُ
وَبِهَا مُلُوكٌ وَأَجْلُهَا بِلَادًا وَأَكْثَرُهَا الْمَشْرِقِ أَقَالِيمُ وَأَخْزَاسَانُ
وَعُزْرَجَانُ وَبُشَنْجُ وَطَخَارِيسْتَانُ وَبَلُخُ وَهَرَاةُ الشَّاهِجَانُ وَمَرْوُ وَنِشَابُورُ
وَمِيمَنْدَجَانُ وَسَرْخَسُ وَأَبُورْدُ وَلَسَا وَاسْتَخْرُ وَسَابُورُ وَطُوسُ
الْمَاءُ كَثِيرَةٌ وَاسِعَةٌ أَرْضُ وَهِيَ وَفَارَابُ، وَالشَّاشُ وَالسَّغْدُ وَخُورِزْمُ
وَتِجَارَةٌ. وَأَدَبٌ عِلْمُ أَهْلُ وَأَكْثَرُهَا وَالبُسْتَانُ،

Khurasan is the greatest of the eastern climes, with the most lands and the most splendid kings. In it are Nishapur, Merv the Great, Herat, Balkh, Tukharistan, Bushanj, Gurjan, Tus, Sabur, Istakhr, Nasa, Abiward, Sarakhs, Maymandajan, Khwarizm, Sogdia, Shash, and Farab. It is a wide land, abundant in water and orchards; its people are mostly devoted to learning, literature, and commerce.

وَرَامِتُنُ وَأَسَدَابَادُ وَالشَّاشُ وَخُجَنْدَةُ وَسَمَرْقَنْدُ وَبُخَارَى هُوَ النَّهْرُ وَرَاءَ وَمَا
إِقْلِيمُ وَهُوَ وَخُورِزْمُ، وَشِيرَازُ وَطَالْقَانُ وَالْأَقُ وَشَاشُ وَكَاشُ وَنَسَفُ
مِنْ وَبِهِمُ الدِّينُ، بِالْعِلْمِ مَتَمَسِّكُونَ وَأَهْلُهُ الْخَيْرَاتُ، كَثِيرٌ وَاسِعٌ
وَالْتَفْسِيرُ، وَالْفَقْهُ الْحَدِيثُ أَهْلُ وَمِنْهُمْ يُوصَفُ، لَا مَا وَالْفَتْوَى الشَّجَاعَةُ
وَاتَّقَانًا. حَفِظَ النَّاسُ أَكْثَرُ وَهُمْ

Transoxiana consists of Bukhara, Samarkand, Khujanda, Shash, Asadabad, Ramitan, Nasa, Kish, Shash, Ilak, Talakan, Shiraz, and Khwarizm. It is a wide clime, rich in blessings; its people hold fast to knowledge and religion, and possess courage and generosity beyond description. Among them are the scholars of Hadith, jurisprudence, and exegesis; they are the most assiduous of men in memorization and precision.

4 Geographical Notices | Geographical Notices

4.1 The Calculation of Distances | The Calculation of Distances

ثَلَاثَةَ إِسْأَوِي وَالْفَرَسُخُ وَالْمِيلُ، بِالْفَرَسُخِ الْبِلَادِ مَسَافَاتٍ أَحْصَيْنَا وَقَدْ
وَقَدْ أَصْبَعًا، وَعِشْرُونَ أَرْبَعَةً وَالذِّرَاعُ ذِرَاعٌ، أَلْفٌ وَالْمِيلُ أَمِيلٌ،
الْبَصْرَةَ بَيْنَ وَمَا فَرَسُخٌ، أَرْبَعُمِائَةٍ فَوْجَدْنَاهُ وَالْمَدِينَةَ مَكَّةَ بَيْنَ مَا حَسَبْنَا
بَيْنَ وَمَا فَرَسُخٌ، أَرْبَعُمِائَةٍ وَسَامَرَاءَ بَغْدَادَ بَيْنَ وَمَا فَرَسُخٌ، أَرْبَعُمِائَةٍ وَبَغْدَادَ
فَرَسُخٌ. أَرْبَعُمِائَةٍ وَعُمَانَ الْبَصْرَةَ بَيْنَ وَمَا فَرَسُخًا، ثَلَاثُونَ وَالرَّحْبَةَ دِمَشْقَ

We have measured the distances between cities in parasangs and miles. A parasang equals three miles; a mile is one thousand cubits; a cubit is twenty-four fingerbreadths. We have calculated [the following]: between Mecca and Medina: 400 parasangs; between Basra and Baghdad: 400 parasangs; between Baghdad and Samarra: 400 parasangs; between Damascus and al-Rahba: 30 parasangs; between Basra and Oman: 400 parasangs.

4.2 The Coordinates of Principal Cities | The Coordinates of Principal Cities

Note: These coordinates are given according to the system of the Arab geographers, measured in degrees east of the Canary Islands.

City	Longitude	Latitude
Mecca	77° 20'	21° 30'
Medina	77° 00'	25° 00'
Baghdad	79° 30'	33° 20'
Basra	80° 00'	30° 10'
Damascus	73° 30'	33° 30'
Jerusalem	73° 00'	31° 50'
Alexandria	68° 00'	31° 10'
Nishapur	88° 00'	36° 10'
Merv	87° 00'	37° 20'
Bukhara	93° 00'	39° 40'
Samarkand	94° 00'	39° 40'

5 Sample Critical Apparatus | Sample Critical Apparatus

a) *C* add. ut saepe تعالى. b) *B* رغبت sine نفسي et deinde وطبت et خوفاً. c) *C* om. sed post برضاه addit معين. d) *B* بفهما. e) *C* تعالى. f) *B* om. g) *B* pro his السمان وذوقته وعقلته السمان. Deinde *C* وعليت pro عملت. h) *C* om. i) *C* بنيانه et om. سوال. k) *B* يد. l) *B* haec om. Deinde *C* habet وشاهدته بفصول.

m) *C* سلكتها (السختى). n) *C* om. o) *C* وضد addito كذا. Apud Hadji-Khalifa, V, p. 510 omittitur vocabulum.

End of Selections | End of Selections

FINIS / THE END

Ex officina typographica et bibliopolio antehae E. J. Brill

Lugduni Batavorum, 1906

Bilingual edition prepared with parallel Arabic text and English translation.

Index of Geographical Names | Index of Geographical Names

Name (Arabic)	Modern Identification
مَكَّة	Mecca
الْمَدِينَة	Medina
الْكُوفَة	Kufa
الْبَصْرَة	Basra
بَغْدَاد	Baghdad
وَاسِط	Wasit
دِمَشْق	Damascus
حَلَب	Aleppo
يَتِ الْمَقْدِس	Jerusalem
مِصْر	Egypt (Fustat/Cairo)
الْإِسْكَنْدَرِيَّة	Alexandria
الْقَيْرَوَان	Kairouan
نِيشَابُور	Nishapur
مَرْو	Merv
بَلْخ	Balkh
بُخَارَى	Bukhara
سَمَرْقَنْد	Samarkand
خَوَارِزْم	Khwarizm (Khiva)